

Company Expense Tracker — Non-Technical Setup Guide

Zero-Coding Setup Guide for Windows & Mac · Everything You Need From Scratch

■ 2 Important Things to Know First:

- 1. Do you need to install React separately? No.** React is already included in the project files. It will be installed automatically with one simple command in Step 3.
- 2. Do you need MySQL or MySQL Workbench? No!** The app uses an embedded database (SQLite) that lives directly inside the project folder. You do **NOT** need to install MySQL, configure servers, or set up passwords.

PART 1: Install the 3 Free Tools (One-Time Only)

1. Node.js	Allows your computer to run the application server.	Download LTS version at: https://nodejs.org <i>Click Next on all prompts to install.</i>
2. Git	Allows you to download (clone) the project files from GitHub.	Download at: https://git-scm.com/downloads <i>Click Next on standard default settings.</i>
3. VS Code	Visual Studio Code makes it easy to open the project and terminal.	Download at: https://code.visualstudio.com <i>Check 'Create desktop icon' & install.</i>

PART 2: Download (Clone) the Project from GitHub

- 1. Open VS Code** on your computer.
- 2. Open the Terminal:** Press **Ctrl + `** (the key above Tab) or click **Terminal > New Terminal** at the top menu.
- 3. Navigate to Desktop:** Type `cd Desktop` and press Enter.
- 4. Download the repository:** Type:
`git clone <YOUR_GITHUB_REPOSITORY_URL>` and press Enter.
- 5. Enter the project folder:** Type `cd Tracker` and press Enter.

PART 3: Automatic 1-Click Setup (Run Once)

Inside that same terminal in VS Code, type this single command:

```
npm run setup
```

■ Your computer will automatically download React, backend modules, and database libraries. Wait 1–2 minutes until finished.

PART 4: Running the App Daily ■

Whenever you want to start the Tracker, run this command in terminal:

```
npm run dev
```

■ **Windows Shortcut:** You can also just go to the Tracker folder and **double-click start.bat!**

Now open your browser (Chrome, Edge, Brave) and visit: <http://localhost:3000>

PART 5: Sign In Credentials

■ **Email:** admin@company.com

■ **Password:** admin123

** You can change your password anytime by clicking the 'Team' button in the top bar > 'Change My Password' tab.*

PART 6: Daily Features Quick Reference

Feature	How to Do It
Add an Expense	Click '+ Add Expense' in the top right. Enter amount in ■ (INR), who you paid, category, and attach receipt (PDF or photo).
View / Download Receipts	Click any receipt thumbnail in the table to open the full invoice with zoom and download buttons.
Add 1–2 Team Members	Click 'Team' in the top navigation bar > enter their Name, Email, Password > click 'Add Person'.
Check Overdue Items	Items pending for 5+ days alert you in a yellow banner or via the ■ bell icon in the top right.
Turn Off the App	Press Ctrl + C in the terminal window (or just close the terminal window).
Start Tomorrow	Run npm run dev (or double-click start.bat) and visit http://localhost:3000 .

PART 7: Emergency Password Recovery (If Locked Out)

Option A (Website UI): On the login page, click '**Forgot password?**' and enter your email with the Master Recovery Key: apex-recovery-key-2026 to reset your password.

Option B (Terminal Failsafe): In your terminal inside the project folder, run:

```
npm run reset-admin MyNewPassword123
```

This will instantly reset the admin password.